



**JABATAN PEMBANGUNAN KEMAHIRAN
KEMENTERIAN SUMBER MANUSIA
ARAS 7 & 8 BLOK D4, KOMPLEKS D
PUSAT PENTADBIRAN KERAJAAN PERSEKUTUAN
62530 PUTRAJAYA**

KERTAS PENERANGAN (*INFORMATION SHEET*)

KOD DAN NAMA PROGRAM / <i>PROGRAM'S CODE AND NAME</i>	Z-009-2:2015 CORE ABILITIES	
TAHAP / LEVEL	2 (TWO)	
NO. DAN TAJUK KEBOLEHAN TERAS / <i>CORE ABILITY NO. AND TITLE</i>	CA03 WORK PLACE CULTURE BEHAVIOR	
NO. DAN PENYATAAN KEBOLEHAN / <i>ABILITY NO. AND STATEMENT</i>	03.01 APPLY PRACTICE WORK CULTURE 03.02 RESPOND APPROPRIATELY TO UNUSUAL SITUATION 03.03 INITIATIVE AND FLEXIBILITY DEMONSTRATION	
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TAJUK/TITLE : UNUSUAL SITUATION RESPONSE

TUJUAN/PURPOSE :

This Information Sheet is intended to describe on the abilities to understand respond procedures and problem identification. The person who is competent in this CA shall be able to respond appropriately to incoming situations.

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PENERANGAN/INFORMATION :

1. Standard operation procedures (SOPs)

Standard operation procedures (SOPs) are document that consist the steps of key processes to ensure consistent and quality output. Employee must understand why these are important tools for the organizations.

1.1 Definition of Standard Operating Procedures

Standard operating procedures (SOPs) are written instructions intended to document how to perform a routine activity. The primary reason many companies rely on SOPs is to help ensuring consistency and quality in their products. SOPs are also useful tools to operationalize and communicate important corporate policies, government regulations and best practices.

1.2 Benefits of SOPs

Many workplace processes require strict adherence to a set of instructions to ensure the intended outcome occurs. Even the best employees don't have perfect memories, so having a set of written instructions they can refer to when performing the steps of the process ensures everything is done correctly. When new employees are trained, SOPs help to keep their training fresh and serve as important reference tools.

Copies of SOPs should be available at the actual location where the work is being done. This will not only ensure employee need them but are able to access them and it also demonstrates the company's efforts to communicate policy and regulation to employees on going basis.

1.3 Examples of SOPs

Any process or task within an organization that management wants can be achieve in the same way each time through benefit from SOPs. Originally, SOPs were popular in the manufacturing environment, since they are an integral part of quality assurance systems.

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2. Response Procedures

Practicing good response and optimise planning will enables your organisation to address short term and long term operational challenges. An immediate challenge will have repercussions, disrupting your short term plan and leaving you with a series of problems to solve for the coming weeks. Allowing the user to rapidly drill down to the root cause and resolve areas of conflict and guide decision making to push exception reports at any platform.

2.1 Responsiveness when you need it most

The ability to make dynamic in response to unforeseen events while maintaining focus on the end to end chain becomes increasingly pivotal. This ability is crucial importance across all area of planning, e.g.: supply, manufacturing and distribution. Through readily available and real time KPIs you are able to quickly evaluate different plans and make intelligent, reality based decisions.

2.2 Enables holistic optimisation in tactical planning

Embedded dashboards, reports and analytics, you will then have the capability to sort through the noise and quickly identify areas of conflict in the short term and integration the long term planning all in a collaborative tool. Value based optimisation are usually driven by flexible objectives. Short term and long term decision making are no longer disjointed but they are merged seamlessly in a holistic approach.

2.3 Problem Solving.

Everybody can benefit from having good problem solving skills as we all encounter problems on a daily basis; some of these problems are obviously more severe or complex than others. It would be wonderful to have the ability to solve all problems efficiently and in a timely fashion without difficulty, unfortunately there is no one way in which all problems can be solved. Problem solving is a very complex subject. However, how well prepared we are for problem solving there is always an element of the unknown. Although planning and structuring will help make the problem solving process more

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likely to be successful, good judgement and an element of good luck will ultimately determine whether problem solving was a success. Poor problem solving may cause interpersonal relationships and business failure. This is often due to either problems not being recognised or being recognised but not being dealt with appropriately. Solving a problem involves a certain amount of risk - this risk needs to be weighed up against not solving the problem. The approach referred to is generally designed for problem solving in an organisation or group context, but can also be easily adapted to work at an individual level. Trying to solve a complex problem alone however can be a mistake, the old adage: "*A problem shared is a problem halved*" is sound advice. Talking to others about problems is not only therapeutic but can help you see things from a different point of view, opening up more potential solutions.

2.4 What is a Problem?

Problem can be defined as a doubtful or difficult matter requiring a solution and something hard to understand or accomplish or deal with. All problems have two features in common and they are goals and barriers.

i. Goals

Problems involve setting out to achieve some objective or desired state of affairs and can include avoiding a situation or event. Goals can be anything that you wish to achieve, where you want to be. If you are hungry then your goal is probably to eat something, if you are a head of an organisation (CEO) then your main goal may be to maximise profits. In the example of the CEO the main goal may need to be split into numerous sub-goals in order to fulfil the ultimate goal of increasing profits.

ii. Barriers

If there were no barriers in the way of achieving a goal, then there would be no problem. Problem solving involves overcoming the barriers or obstacles that prevent the immediate achievement of goals. Of course for the CEO wanting to increase profits there may be many more barriers preventing the goal from being reached. The CEO needs to recognise these barriers and remove them or find other ways to achieve the goals of the organisation.

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2.5

Problem Solving Stages

Effective problem solving usually involves working through a number of steps or stages, such as those outlined below.

i. Problem Identification

Detecting and recognising that there is a problem; identifying the nature of the problem; defining the problem. The first phase of problem solving may sound obvious but often requires more thought and analysis. Identifying a problem can be a difficult task in itself, is there a problem at all? What is the nature of the problem, are there in fact numerous problems? How can the problem be best defined? - by spending some time defining the problem you will not only understand it more clearly yourself but be able to communicate its nature to others, this leads to the second phase.

ii. Structuring the Problem

A period of observation, careful inspection, fact-finding and developing a clear picture of the problem. Following on from the problem identification, structuring the problem is all about gaining more information about the problem and increasing understanding it. This phase is all about fact finding and analysis, building a more comprehensive picture of both the goal(s) and the barrier(s). This stage may not be necessary for very simple problems but is essential for problems of a more complex nature.

iii. Looking for Possible Solutions

During this stage you will generate a range of possible courses of action, but with little attempt to evaluate them at this stage. From the information gathered in the first two phases of the problem solving framework it is now time to start thinking about possible solutions to the identified problem. In a group situation this stage is often carried out as a brain-storming session, letting each person in the group express their views on possible solutions (or part solutions). In organisations different people will have different expertise in different

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areas and it is useful, therefore, to hear the views of each concerned party.

iv. **Decision Making**

Stages that involves careful analysis of the different possible courses of action and then selecting the best solution for implementation. This is perhaps the most complex part of the problem solving process. Following on from the previous step it is now time to look at each potential solution and carefully analyse it. Some solutions may not be possible, due to other problems, like time constraints or budgets. It is important at this stage to also consider what might happen if nothing was done to solve the problem - sometimes trying to solve a problem that leads to many more problems requires some very creative thinking and innovative ideas. Finally, make a decision on which course of action to take - decision making is an important skill in itself.

v. **Implementation**

This stage involves accepting and carrying out the chosen course of action. Implementation means acting on the chosen solution. During implementation more problems may arise especially if identification or structuring of the original problem was not carried out fully.

3. Communication Skills

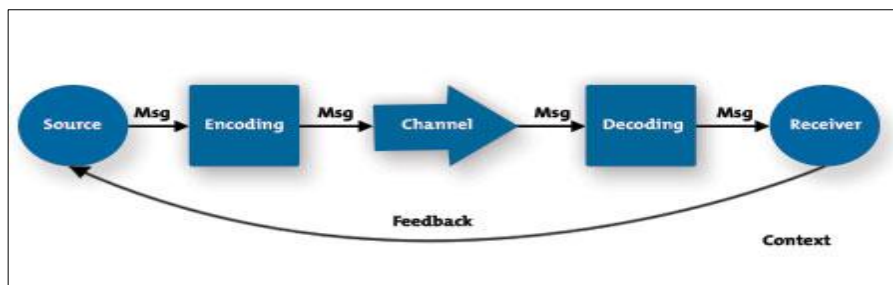
The purpose of communication is to get your message across to others clearly and unambiguously. Doing this involves effort from both the sender and receiver of the message, it is a process that can be fraught with error where messages are often misinterpreted by the recipient. If this isn't detected, it may cause tremendous confusion, wasted effort and missed opportunity. Communication is only successful when both the sender and receiver understand the same information as a result of communication. Successfully getting your message across, you convey your thoughts and ideas effectively. When not successful, the thoughts and ideas that you convey do not necessarily reflect your own, causing a communications breakdown and creating roadblocks that stand in the way of your goals – both personally and professionally. In spite of the increasing importance placed on communication skills, many individuals continue to struggle with this, unable to communicate their thoughts and ideas

effectively – whether in verbal or written format. This inability makes it nearly impossible for them to compete effectively in the workplace, and stands in the way of career progression.

Getting your message across is paramount to progressing and to do this you must understand what your message is all about, what audience you are sending it to and how it will be perceived. You must also weigh-in circumstances surrounding your communications, such as situational and cultural context.

3.1 The Importance of Removing Barriers in Communications Skills

Communication barriers can pop-up at every stage of the communication process (which consists of sender, message, channel, receiver, feedback and context – see the diagram below) and have the potential to create misunderstanding and confusion.



From “The Mathematical Theory of Communication,” Copyright 1994, 1998, by the Board of Trustees of the University of Illinois.

To be an effective communicator and to get your point across without misunderstanding and confusion, your goal should be to lessen the frequency of these barriers at each stage of this process with clear, concise, accurate, well planned communications with the following processes below.

i. Source of message

You need to be clear about why you're communicating, and what you want to communicate. You also need to be confident that the information you're communicating is useful and accurate.

ii. Message

The message is the information that you want to communicate.

iii. Encoding

Process of transferring the information you want to communicate into a form that can be sent and correctly decoded at the other end. Your success in encoding depends partly on your ability to convey information clearly and simply, also on your ability to anticipate and eliminate sources of confusion (for example, cultural issues, mistaken assumptions, and missing information.) A key part of this is knowing your audience: Failure to understand who you are communicating with will result in delivering messages that are misunderstood.

iv. Channel

Messages are conveyed through channels, with verbal including face-to-face meetings, telephone and video conferencing; and written including letters, emails, memos, and reports.

Different channels might have different strengths and weaknesses. For example, it's not particularly effective to give a long list of directions verbally, while you'll quickly cause problems if you criticize someone strongly by email.

v. Decoding

Successful encoding is a skill, so is successful decoding (involving, for example, taking the time to read a message carefully, or listen actively and effectively to it.) Just as confusion can arise from errors in encoding, it can also arise from decoding errors. This is particularly the case if the decoder doesn't have enough knowledge to understand the message.

vi. Receiver

Your message is delivered to individual members of your audience. No doubt, you have in mind the actions or reactions you hope your message will get from this audience. Keep in mind, though, that each of these individuals enters into the communication process with ideas and feelings that will undoubtedly influence their understanding of your message, and their response. To be a successful communicator, you should consider these before delivering your message, and act appropriately.

vii. Feedback

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Your audience will provide you with feedback, verbal and nonverbal reactions to your communicated message. Pay close attention to this feedback, as it is the only thing that allows you to be confident that your audience has understood your message. If you find that there has been a misunderstanding, at least you have the opportunity to send the message a second time.

viii. Context

The situation in which your message is delivered is the context. This may include the surrounding environment or broader culture (corporate culture, international cultures, and so on).

3.2 Removing Barriers at All These Stages

To deliver your messages effectively, you must commit to breaking down the barriers that exist in each of these stages of the communication process. If your message is too lengthy, disorganized, or contains errors, you can expect the message to be misunderstood and misinterpreted. Barriers in context tend to stem from senders offering too much information too fast. Use of poor verbal and body language can also confuse the message. When in doubt here, less is oftentimes more. It is best to be mindful of the demands on other people's time, especially in today's ultra-busy society.

Once you understand this, you need to work to understand your audience's culture, making sure you can converse and deliver your message to people of different backgrounds and cultures within your own organization, in this country and even abroad.

4. Authority Level

Empowerment is often incorrectly perceived as a binary choice, either you empower someone, or you don't. In reality, your options are more varied than that. We can distinguish between different levels of authority. *“Empowerment is a continuous variable; people can be viewed as more or less empowered, rather than empowered or not empowered.”* – G.M. Spreitzer.

For each individual activity we can distinguish seven levels of authority (modified from Susan M. Heathfield):

- 4.1 **Level 1: Tell:** You make decisions and announce them to your people. (This is actually not empowerment at all.)

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- 4.2 **Level 2: Sell:** You make decisions, but you attempt to gain commitment from workers by “selling” your idea to them.
- 4.3 **Level 3: Consult:** You invite and weigh input from workers before coming to a decision. But you make it clear that it's you who is making the decisions.
- 4.4 **Level 4: Join:** You invite workers to join in a discussion and to reach consensus as a group. Your voice is equal to the others.
- 4.5 **Level 5: Advise:** You attempt to influence workers by telling them what your opinion is, but ultimately you leave it up to them to decide.
- 4.6 **Level 6: Confirm:** You let the team decide first, with the suggestion that it would be nice, though not strictly necessary, if they are able to convince you afterward.
- 4.7 **Level 7: Delegate:** You leave it entirely up to the team to deal with the matter, while you go out and have a good time.

These levels of authority can be vary depending on the topic, for example:

- 4.8 I told our people that I would be starting a new business unit in our organization. (There was no reason for selling this to our employees, because the one I had to sell it to was our CEO.)
- 4.9 I did sell the business model, and what type of customers we're after, to the people that I selected to join me in my effort.
- 4.10 For the name of our business unit I decided to consult all team members, asking for their ideas.
- 4.11 When it was time to select a logo, I invited all team members to join me in ranking and rating the different designs.
- 4.12 The technical design of our product is ultimately a team responsibility, though I did advise them concerning some architectural issues.
- 4.13 I don't really care who is doing what in the team, but I do appreciate it when they ask me sometimes to confirm that they made the right choices.
- 4.14 Finally, I delegate all the hard work. I was involved in coding for a while, but none of my code survived the team's refactoring efforts, so I've deduced that I'm better at adding value in other areas.

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Every topic requires its own level of authority, and the further you go the better it is. But in some cases, it is best to start by telling or selling, and then **gradually increase the authority of team members as their experience grows.**

"The best way to empower team members is gradually and systematically. [...]

Responsibilities for self-management and decision making should be turned over to employees on an as-ready basis."

– S. Caudron

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SOALAN/QUESTION :

1. Write down what is Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) in brief.

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2. What are the benefits of "standard operation procedures (SOP)" in the organisation?

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3. Explain in brief what is response procedures and address two(2) response procedure guidance in decision making.

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4. Why is moving of barriers in communication skills becomes very important?

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RUJUKAN / REFERENCES:

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